

PS.-CHRYSOSTOM DE JEJUNIO 4
(PG 60:715-718 = CPG 4619)
DRAFT TRANSLATION

Document Control

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Contents and Disclaimer

Over a number of years and across numerous studies, Voicu has identified thirty-seven works in the pseudo-Chrysostomica which he argues can be attributed to a single author, one he calls the ‘anonymous Cappadocian’ (or PxmCapp).¹ Over coming months, as time permits, I hope to translate a few of them, as this author’s works are certainly among the more interesting among the spuria.²

This document contains a draft English translation of Ps.-Chrysostom *De Jejuno 4* (PG 60:715-718 = CPG 4619 = RP 13), one of the thirty-seven homilies Voicu attributes to the Cappadocian. It is presented along with the Greek text and Latin translation transcribed from Migne. The paragraph divisions however, are mine.

As usual this is a fairly literal first draft. I have opted to translate participles as participles where possible, rather than add my own interpretation as to whether a participle is temporal or causal and so on. I figure that if the author had wished to add more precision, they would have done so.

Comments and corrections always welcome. E-mail to Kathie at inepti.graeculi@gmail.com



¹ For a chronological summary, including bibliographic references to the key studies, a list of the 37 homilies identified to date, and an edition of the thirty-seventh, see Sever J Voicu, “L’Omelia *Quod filii debeant honorare parentes* (CPG 5092) di uno Pseudocrisostomo Cappadoce,” in Ambrogio M. Piazzoni ed. *Studi in Onore del Cardinale Raffaele Farina II* (Studi e Testi 478; Città del Vaticano: Biblioteca Apostolica Vaticana 2013), 1197-1221. With my huge thanks to Sever Voicu for a copy of this article.

² I will write more on Voicu’s findings in an introduction to another translation.

Ps.Chrys jejun.4 (PG 60:715-718)

De Jejunio
Sermo 4

Περὶ νηστείας.
Λόγος δ'.

Concerning Fasting.
Homily 4

1 Fontes hausti puriorem aquam emittunt, atque omnium usum sitimque explentes ex scaturigine semper fluunt. Possunt ergo singuli pro necessitate sitim sedare, dives, pauper, sapiens, idiota: omnibusque fontes potum affatim subministrantes, inexhaustum habent thesaurum. Sicut ergo fons unus multis potum praebet: sic una Scriptura multorum mentes illustrat. Venite igitur et vos, dilecti, ad prius memoratum fontem pergamus, et doctrinae de jejuniis consortes simus. Nam ut id divitiis satis fuit: sic et nobis utpote pauperibus non deficiet.

2 Jejunans Elias auriga ille, melote et virga fluvium secuit; idemque jejunans caelos clausit: verbo namque nubes imbrium clausit. Cum jejunasset, etiam igneos equos frenavit, curruque flammeo in caelum vectus est: cum jejunasset Moyses Dei servus, horrendum pelagus discidit, et piscosum mare in aridam mutavit, assumptosque Hebraeos servavit, atque Aegyptios in mare demersit. Jejunium Moysis virgam sanctam in dextera ejus posuit, ac per eam ille petram percutiens, aquam potabilem

1 Αἱ τῶν ὑδάτων πηγαὶ ἀντλούμεναι καθαρώτερον τὸ ὕδωρ βλυστάνουσι, καὶ πάντων τὴν χρεῖαν καὶ τὴν δίψαν πληροῦσαι ἄπαυστον ἐκ λαγόνων τὸ νᾶμα πηγάζουσιν. Ἐξεστὶν οὖν πᾶσι κατὰ τὴν οἰκείαν χρεῖαν τὸ νᾶμα τῆς δίψης ἐκεῖθεν ἀρύσασθαι, πλουσίῳ τε καὶ πένητι, σοφῷ τε καὶ ἰδιώτῃ· καὶ πᾶσιν αἱ πηγαὶ τὸν πότον πλουσίως παρέχουσαι, ἀνεξάντλητον ἔχουσι τὸν θησαυρόν. Καθάπερ οὖν μία πηγὴ τὰ τῶν πολλῶν στόματα ποτίζει· οὕτω καὶ μία Γραφή τῶν πολλῶν νοήματα φωτίζει. Δεῦτε τοίνυν καὶ ὑμεῖς, ἀγαπητοί, ἐπὶ τὴν τοῦ προλαβόντος πηγὴν ὁρμήσωμεν, καὶ τῆς διδασκαλίας τῶν νηστειῶν κοινωνήσωμεν. Καὶ γὰρ καὶ τοῦτο ὥς πλουσίῳ ἐπῆρκεσε, καὶ ἡμῖν ὥς πένησιν οὐκ ἐξέλειπε.

2 Νηστεύσας Ἠλίας ὁ ἄρματηλάτης, μῆλωτῇ καὶ ῥάβδῳ τὸν ποταμὸν ἐδίχασεν. Ὁ αὐτὸς νηστεύσας οὐρανούς ἐκλείσει· ῥήματι γὰρ τὰς ὀμβροτόκους νεφέλας ἐκλειδούχησεν. Ὁ αὐτὸς νηστεύσας πυρίνους ἵππους ἡνίαίς χαλινώσας, φλογίνῳ ἄρματι εἰς οὐρανούς ἡνιόχησε. Νηστεύσας Μωϋσῆς ὁ τοῦ Θεοῦ θεράπων φοβερὸν πέλαγος ἐρῥήξε, καὶ τὴν ἰχθυοφόρον εἰς ἄρουραν μετέστρεψε, καὶ τοὺς Ἑβραίους ἄρας ἔσωσε, καὶ τοὺς Αἰγυπτίους κατεπόντισε. Νηστεία Μωϋσέως

1 Flowing springs of water bubble forth purer water, and unceasingly gush forth from their wells, satisfying the need and thirst of all. It is therefore possible for all, in accordance with their individual need of drink, to draw water there: rich and poor, wise and unskilled. And the springs abundantly supplying drink to all have inexhaustible treasure. Therefore, just as one spring gives the mouths of many to drink, so too one Scripture illuminates the minds of many. Come therefore, you too, beloved. Let us proceed to the aforementioned spring, and partake of the teaching about fasting. For just as this sufficed for the rich, so too for us poor it did not fail.

2 Fasting, Elijah the charioteer, divided the river in two with sheepskin and rod. The same one, fasting, shut the heavens – for with a word he kept the rain-producing clouds in check. The same one, fasting, bridled fiery horses [and] drove a flaming chariot to the heavens. Fasting, Moses the servant of God split a formidable sea apart, and turned the fish-producing [sea] into cornland, and lifting up the Hebrews saved [them], and plunged the Egyptians into the sea. Fasting, endowing grace to the holy

Ps.Chrys jejun.4 (PG 60:715-718)

subministravit. Jejunium Danieli sapientiam indens, somniorum interpretem arcanorum exhibuit illum. Idem ipse jejunans in lacu feras frenavit : leonum pastor effectus, ipsos in caelum respicere docuit. Jejunium trium puerorum corpora incorrupta servavit, voracemque Babylonicae fornacis flammam in rorem commutavit. Per jejunium Jonas propheta cetum refrenavit, ipsoque velut subjugali usus, Niniven concessit. Non enim animal illud quo libuit perrexit, sed quo voluit intus positus auriga, illuc cete pervenit. Jejunantes Ninivite urbem servaverunt, et prophetae plantam marcidam reddiderunt.

3 Jejunium Dei donum est, angelorum esca ; jejunium Moysem mysteriis initiavit, Abraham fidelem reddidit; jejunium Isaacum justificavit, jejunium cum Jacobo peregrinatum est, jejunium Josephum clarum effecti, jejunium Melchisedecum exaltavit, Lotum ex Sodomis eripuit : jejunium cum Jobo certavit, jejunium prophetas sapientia replevit, jejunium reges potentes effecit, jejunium sacerdotes initiavi,

δεξιὰν ῥάβδῳ ἁγία χαριτώσασα, καὶ δι' αὐτῆς τὴν πέτραν πατάξασα, ὕδωρ πότιμον καρποφορῆσαι παρεσκεύασε. Νηστεία τὸν Δανιὴλ σοφίσασα, τῶν ἀψηλαφήτων ἐνυπνίων μυσταγωγὸν ἀπεδείκνυεν. Ὁ αὐτὸς νηστεύσας τοὺς ἐν λάκκῳ θῆρας ἐφίμωσε, καὶ τῶν λεόντων ποιμὴν γενόμενος, εἰς οὐρανοὺς ἀναβλέπειν τούτους ἐπαιδαγώγησε. Νηστεία τῶν τριῶν παίδων τὰ σώματα ἀδιάφθορα τηρήσασα, τὴν παμφάγον φλόγα τῆς Βαβυλωνίας καμίνου εἰς δρόσον μετέβαλε· νηστεία Ἰωνᾶς ὁ προφήτης τὸ κῆτος χαλινώσας, καθάπερ ὑποζυγίῳ χρησάμενος, εἰς τὴν Νινευὶ ἐπορεύετο. Οὐ γὰρ ὅπου ἤθελε τὸ ζῶον, ἀπῆρχετο, ἀλλ' ὅπου ὁ ἔνδον ἡνιοχῶν ἐβούλετο, ἐκεῖ τὸ κῆτος ἐπορεύετο. Νηστεύσαντες Νινευῖται τὴν πόλιν διέσωσαν, καὶ τὸ φυτὸν τοῦ προφήτου ἐμάραναν.

3 Νηστεία Θεοῦ χάρισμα, νηστεία ἀγγέλων τροφή· νηστεία τὸν Μωϋσῆν ἐμυσταγώγησε, νηστεία τὸν Ἀβραὰμ ἐπιστώσατο, νηστεία τὸν Ἰσαὰκ ἐδικαίωσε, νηστεία σὺν τῷ Ἰακώβ ἐξενίτευσε, νηστεία τὸν Ἰωσήφ ἐσέμνυνε, νηστεία τὸν Μελχισεδέχ ὕψωσε, νηστεία τὸν Λῶτ ἐκ Σοδόμων ἤρπασε, νηστεία σὺν τῷ Ἰὼβ ἥθλησε, νηστεία προφήτας ἐσόφισε, νηστεία βασιλεῖς ἐδυνάμωσε, νηστεία ἱερεῖς

rod in the right hand of Moses, and with this striking the rock, produced fresh water. Fasting, making Daniel wise, disclosed the interpretation of untested dreams. The same one, fasting, muzzled the beasts in the pit and, becoming the shepherd of lions, trained these to look up to heaven. Fasting maintained the bodies of the three youths incorruptible, changed the all-consuming flame of the Babylonian furnace into dew. By fasting, Jonah the prophet, bridled the sea-monster, using [it] just like an ass, [and] went to Nineveh. For not where the creature wished, did he go, but where the one inside driving wanted, there the sea monster went. By fasting, the Ninevites saved their city, and withered the plant of the prophet.

3 Fasting is a gift of God's grace, fasting is the food of angels. Fasting initiated Moses, fasting made Abraham trustworthy, fasting justified Isaac, fasting exiled Jacob, fasting magnified Joseph, fasting exalted Melchizedek, fasting snatched Lot out of Sodom, fasting contended with Job, fasting made prophets wise, fasting empowered kings, fasting perfected priests, fasting illuminated Moses, fasting was a

Ps.Chrys jejun.4 (PG 60:715-718)

jejunium Moysi facem praetulit, jejunium eum Aarone sacerdotio functum est, jejunium cum Jesu Nave exercitum duxit, jejunium Gedeonem armavit, jejunium Samsonem roboravit, jejunium Samuelem parturivit, jejunium cum Saule bellum gessit, jejunium Isaiam benedixit, jejunium Jeremiae loquellam indidit, jejunium Zachariam sanctificavit, jejunium Joanni sapientiam attulit, jejunium Petro vim indidit, jejunium Paulo bravia conciliavit, jejunium orbem obsignavit, jejunium vim ignis calcavit, jejunium leonum genus debile reddidit, jejunium draconum ferocitatem restinxit, jejunium fluvios exiccavit; jejunium paradisi restitutio, jejunium supra dictorum caput, corpus Christi custodivit, diaboli impetus strenue excepit; jejunium virginum consors, jejunium domorum augmentum, jejunium poenitentium advocatus, jejunium orationi conjugatum est, jejunium principium divitiarum, jejunium pauperum consolation, jejunium laborantium auxilium, jejunium somnum depellens, et hymnum inducens, jejunium aqua est, quam potamus, quae immortalitatis fontem nobis subministrat.

ἐτελείωσε, νηστεία Μωϋσῆν ἐλαμπαδούχησε, νηστεία σὺν τῷ Ἀαρὼν ἱεράτευσε, νηστεία Ἰησοῦ Ναυὴ συνεστρατήγησε, νηστεία τὸν Γεδεὼν ὥπλισε, νηστεία τὸν Σαμψὼν ἠνδρείωσε, νηστεία τὸν Σαμουὴλ ἐκύησε, νηστεία σὺν τῷ Σαοὺλ ἐπολέμησε, νηστεία τὸν Ἡσαΐαν εὐλόγησε, νηστεία τὸν Ἰερεμίαν ἐστόμωσε, νηστεία τὸν Ζαχαρίαν ἡγίασε, νηστεία τὸν Ἰωάννην ἐσόφισε, νηστεία Πέτρῳ ἐπήρκεσε, νηστεία Παύλῳ ἐβράβευσε, νηστεία τὴν οἰκουμένην ἐσφράγισε, νηστεία δύναμιν πυρὸς κατεπάτησε, νηστεία ἔθνος λεόντων ἐμάρανε, νηστεία γαυρίαμα δρακόντων κατέσβεσε, νηστεία ποταμοὺς ἐξήρανε· νηστεία τοῦ παραδείσου ἀποκατάστασις, νηστεία ἐπὶ τοῖς εἰρηνέμοις κεφάλαιον, τὸ σῶμα τοῦ Χριστοῦ ὀχυρώσασα, τὰς προσβολὰς τοῦ διαβόλου σφοδρῶς ὑπεδέξατο. Νηστεία παρθένων συνόμιλος, νηστεία οἰκῶν αὐξησις, νηστεία μετανοούντων συνήγορος, νηστεία προσευχῆς ὁμόζυγος, νηστεία πλούτου ἀρχὴ, νηστεία πενήτων παράκλησις, νηστεία καταπονουμένων βοηθός, νηστεία ὕπνον ἐλαύνουσα, καὶ ὕμνον ἐπάγουσα, νηστεία ὕδωρ ἡμᾶς ποτίζουσα, καὶ ἀθανασίας πηγὴν ἡμῖν καταρτίζουσα.

priest with Aaron, fasting was a fellow-general with Jesus Nave,³ fasting armed Gideon, fasting reared Samson into manhood, fasting conceived Samuel, fasting warred with Saul, fasting blessed Isaiah, fasting furnished Jeremiah with eloquence, fasting sanctified Zechariah, fasting made John wise, fasting assisted Peter, fasting awarded a prize to Paul, fasting sealed the whole world, fasting trampled down the power of fire, fasting enfeebled the class of lions, fasting extinguished the arrogance of dragons, fasting dried up streams. Fasting is the re-establishment of paradise. Fasting, above all that has been said, fortifying the body of Christ, vigorously took on the assaults of the devil. Fasting, companion of virgins. Fasting, increase of households, Fasting, advocate of the repenting. Fasting, yoke-fellow of prayer. Fasting, sovereign of wealth. Fasting, comfort of the poor. Fasting, helper of the oppressed. Fasting, driving away sleep and leading in a hymn. Fasting, giving us water to drink and restoring for us the spring of immortality.

³ I.e. Joshua.

Ps.Chrys jejun.4 (PG 60:715-718)

4 O jejunium, quod solo pane animas nostras ad peitatem disponit, et sale peccatorum nostrorum foetorem abstergit! o jejunium quod per quadraginta dies aerem nobis per gradus disponit, quibus nos ad caelum deducit! o jejunium per os jejunantium misericordiam et iudicium Dei attemperans, ut modo audivimus. David enim, qui sanctorum prophetarum chorus est, justum iudicium cum misericordia mixtum, futurum nempe iudicium nobis describens Deo dicebat, *Misericordiam et iudicium cantabo tibi, Domine* (Psal. 100.1). Jejunium cum Cherubinis versans, jejunium cum Seraphinis habitans, jejunium Enochum in paradisi domo constituens, in Christo Jesu Domino nostro, cui gloria et imperium in saecula. Amen.

4 Ὡς νηστεία, ἡ ἄρτω τὰς ψυχὰς ἡμῶν πρὸς εὐσέβειαν εὐτρεπίζουσα, καὶ ἅλατι τὴν δυσωδίαν τῶν ἀμαρτημάτων ἡμῶν ἀποσμήχουσα· ὃ νηστεία τεσσαράκοντα ἡμέρας τὸν ἀέρα βαθμώσασα, καὶ ἡμᾶς εἰς οὐρανοὺς δι' ἐκείνων ἄγουσα· ὃ νηστεία διὰ στόματος νηστευόντων ἔλεον καὶ κρίσιν τῷ Θεῷ κελαδοῦσα, ὡς νῦν ἠκούσαμεν τῶν εἰρημένων. Δαυὶδ γὰρ, ὁ τῶν ἁγίων προφητῶν ὁ χορὸς, δικαιοκρισίαν ἐλέω μεμιγμένην, τὴν μέλλουσαν κρίσιν ἀρτίως ἡμῖν ὑπογράφων, ἔλεγε πρὸς τὸν Θεόν· Ἔλεον καὶ κρίσιν ἄσομαί σοι, Κύριε. Νηστεία τῶν Χερουβὶμ ὁμοδίαιτος, νηστεία τῶν Σεραφὶμ σύσκηνος, νηστεία τὸν Ἐνῶχ εἰς παράδεισον ὤκισεν, ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ τῷ Κυρίῳ ἡμῶν, ᾧ ἡ δόξα καὶ τὸ κράτος εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας. Ἀμήν.

4 O fasting, the one who makes our souls ready for piety with bread, and wipes away the stench of our sins with salt! O fasting, providing the air with steps for forty days, and leading us by them to the heavens! O fasting, sounding mercy and justice like flowing waters to God through the mouth of those fasting, as we heard mentioned just now! For David, the chorus-leader of the holy prophets, describing to us just now righteous judgement mixed with mercy, the coming judgement, said to God: *'Of mercy and justice I will sing to you, O Lord* (Ps 100 [=101]:1 LXX).' Fasting, co-dweller with cherubim; fasting, tent-mate of seraphim; fasting transplanted Enoch into paradise, in Christ Jesus our Lord, to whom be the glory and the power into the ages. Amen.